CRIMINALIZING REPORTING

Uganda v. Moses Bwayo

9 October 2026

CASE FOLLOW-UP REPORT

Procedural developments and verified outcomes

Independent research based on user-supplied TrialWatch materials

ABOUT THIS UPDATE

This independent research update follows the user-supplied TrialWatch material. It is not issued by the Clooney Foundation for Justice, TrialWatch, or the original authors. The earlier report supplies the historical baseline; later developments are supported by the sources cited here.

Jurisdiction	Uganda
Original report	January 2021
Dated update covered	10 December 2025
Research cutoff	9 October 2026
Historical assessment	TrialWatch grade C (original report only)

SCOPE AND METHOD

Research considered public court records, enacted legislation, lawyers and subjects, press-freedom organizations, United Nations materials and attributable reporting available through 9 October 2026. Publication dates and event dates are distinguished. Where judgments or current custody records could not be obtained, the conclusion is expressly qualified. No direct interviews or new trial monitoring were conducted for this update.

An acquittal, quashing order, pardon, sentence completion, bail decision and custody transfer have different legal effects. A reported intention to litigate is separated from an actual filing. Unresolved questions are listed below. Historical TrialWatch grades retain their original attribution; this update does not assign a new grade.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

LATEST VERIFIED POSITION

Charge dismissed in August 2020; no reinstatement verified

The latest verified follow-up is an official film-program announcement crediting Bwayo, not a court outcome. Dismissal for want of prosecution on 10 August 2020 was already in the original. His April 2024 first-person account places his move to the United States in March 2022 and describes seeking asylum; a grant was not verified. A same-name Ugandan civil case is an unconfirmed lead, not an attributed lawsuit or judgment.

Moses Bwayo's unlawful-assembly prosecution was dismissed for want of prosecution on 10 August 2020. This was already the result recorded in the January 2021 TrialWatch report, not a later acquittal. No reinstatement or appeal of that dismissal was verified in the searches through 9 October 2026. [1]

The material post-report development is Bwayo's reported departure from Uganda. His April 2024 first-person account dates his move to the United States to March 2022 and describes seeking asylum. The latest verified follow-up, a Sundance announcement of 10 December 2025, credits him as a producer of a film selected for the 2026 festival. It establishes continued professional activity, not a new legal disposition or an asylum grant. [4] [5]

1. User-supplied original report, January 2021.

4. International Documentary Assoc..., 25 April 2024. Field Recording: We Are Removing a Dictator

5. Sundance Institute, 10 December 2025. 2026 Sundance Film Festival unveils 97 select...

BACKGROUND AND PROCEDURAL HISTORY

Bwayo was filming opposition politician and musician Robert Kyagulanyi, known as Bobi Wine, on a Kampala hotel rooftop on 24 February 2020 when police detained him. He was released on police bond on 26 February, arrested again and charged on 4 March with eight other people, remanded to Luzira Prison, and granted bail on 6 March. The charge was unlawful assembly. On 10 August, the Makindye Chief Magistrate's Court declined another adjournment and dismissed the prosecution after witnesses failed to appear. [1]

The ABA Center for Human Rights staff experts assigned the proceedings a C grade. The report identified concerns about the arrests, detention, charging basis and prosecution's failure to advance the case. Dismissal was not a merits judgment establishing innocence. The original also discussed Bwayo being shot in the face while filming in November 2020; because that event preceded the report, it must not be presented as newly discovered post-report violence. [1]

KEY PROCEDURAL DATES

24 February 2020	Detention while filming Bobi Wine; police bond followed on 26 February. [1]
4 March 2020	Rearrest, unlawful-assembly charge and remand; bail followed on 6 March. [1]
10 August 2020	Court dismissed the charge for want of prosecution. [1]
November 2020	Shooting while filming, already described in the original report. [1]
January 2021	Original TrialWatch report published, including dismissal and subsequent 2020 violence. [1]
23 July 2021	ABA webpage published the report summary; not a new dismissal date. [2]
March 2022	Move to the United States, retrospectively dated in Bwayo's April 2024 essay. [4]
26 November 2023	Irish Times profile reported departure from Uganda and seeking asylum, and recalled the dropped prosecution. [3]
25 April 2024	Bwayo published a first-person account of flight, threats and seeking asylum. [4]
10 December 2025	Sundance's 2026 selection announcement credited Bwayo as a KikuyuLand producer. [5]

1. User-supplied original report, January 2021.
2. American Bar Association Center..., 23 July 2021. Fair Trial Report: Uganda v. Moses Bwayo
3. The Irish Times, 26 November 2023. Bobi Wine documentary maker forced to flee Ug...
4. International Documentary Assoc..., 25 April 2024. Field Recording: We Are Removing a Dictator
5. Sundance Institute, 10 December 2025. 2026 Sundance Film Festival unveils 97 select...

SUBSEQUENT DEVELOPMENTS

ABA's July 2021 webpage reiterates the historical dismissal. It is a later publication of the existing result, not evidence of a second proceeding. The November 2023 Irish Times profile independently recalls that the case was eventually dropped, while reporting that Bwayo had left Uganda and was seeking asylum in the United States. It also describes interference with his filmmaking. [2] [3]

Bwayo's April 2024 essay supplies the more specific March 2022 relocation date. He describes threats, two attempted kidnappings of his wife, and the risks of return. These are attributed firsthand allegations, not adjudicated findings. His reference to seeking asylum supports an application-stage description only; the research did not establish a grant. The official Sundance selection announcement later supplies independent evidence of continued film work. [4] [5]

A Ugandan High Court cause list generated on 7 November 2025 names a Moses Bwayo against the Inspector General of Police and Attorney General in civil matter HCT-00-CV-MC-0019-2022, seeking declaratory orders and costs. This is an unresolved identity and linkage lead. No located pleading or judgment establishes that the claimant is this filmmaker or that the claim concerns the 2020 arrest. A cause list does not prove that the listed hearing occurred or disclose an outcome. It is therefore excluded from the verified case chronology. [6]

LEGAL AND PROCEDURAL ASSESSMENT

The following assessment draws inferences from the cited record. It does not represent a new court finding or TrialWatch grade.

termination of this prosecution and safety after termination are separate questions. The original's dismissal establishes that the charge did not proceed at that point. Later flight accounts explain why that procedural outcome cannot be treated as restoration of safe working conditions. Neither flight nor the absence of a located reinstatement decision establishes the present status of every possible proceeding. [1] [3] [4]

dismissal for want of prosecution should not be called an acquittal on the evidence. Nor should the same-name civil listing be upgraded into a successful rights claim, a damages award, or even a verified filing by this subject. The necessary missing link is an attributable case document identifying the claimant and the underlying incident. [1] [6]

1. User-supplied original report, January 2021.
2. American Bar Association Center..., 23 July 2021. Fair Trial Report: Uganda v. Moses Bwayo
3. The Irish Times, 26 November 2023. Bobi Wine documentary maker forced to flee Ug...
4. International Documentary Assoc..., 25 April 2024. Field Recording: We Are Removing a Dictator
5. Sundance Institute, 10 December 2025. 2026 Sundance Film Festival unveils 97 select...
6. Judiciary of Uganda, 7 November 2025. High Court Kampala Civil Division cause list,...

CONCLUSION AND OUTSTANDING RECORDS

The supported legal status remains the original August 2020 dismissal, with later reported exile and continued filmmaking. Retain the original C grade with attribution. Further conclusions about reinstatement, asylum status or civil redress require records not obtained in this research. [1] [4] [5]

RECORDS NOT VERIFIED

1. Was the unlawful-assembly charge ever reinstated, or was the dismissal challenged? Obtain the later Makindye docket entries.

2. What is the current asylum status? Seeking asylum in the 2023-2024 accounts is not evidence that it was granted.

3. Is the claimant in HCT-00-CV-MC-0019-2022 the filmmaker, and does the matter concern the arrests monitored by TrialWatch? Obtain the originating motion and any ruling before attributing it.

4. Was there an investigation, accountability decision or compensation concerning the arrests or November 2020 shooting? No attributable outcome was verified.

5. Did any of the eight co-accused have a different subsequent outcome? The subject-focused later sources do not establish their status.

Failure to locate an update leaves a gap in the available evidence; it does not establish that no later proceeding or change occurred. Any present-status claim should be read with the dated scope stated in the executive summary.

1. User-supplied original report, January 2021.

4. International Documentary Assoc..., 25 April 2024. Field Recording: We Are Removing a Dictator

5. Sundance Institute, 10 December 2025. 2026 Sundance Film Festival unveils 97 select...

SOURCES AND REFERENCES

Numbered references correspond to superscript citations and page notes. Web sources were consulted for this research through 9 October 2026. Original reports are local user-supplied files. Each link opens the cited source.

1. **Original user-supplied report on Uganda v. Moses Bwayo**
TrialWatch / original report authors. January 2021.
Local PDF: uganda-v-moses-bwayo.pdf
Coverage: Historical case baseline and original assessment

2. **Fair Trial Report: Uganda v. Moses Bwayo**
American Bar Association Center for Human Rights. 23 July 2021.
Read source at www.americanbar.org
Coverage: Historical dismissal for want of prosecution; Webpage date must not be mistaken for the dismissal date

3. **Bobi Wine documentary maker forced to flee Uganda**
The Irish Times. 26 November 2023.
Read source at www.irishtimes.com
Coverage: Departure from Uganda and seeking US asylum; Prosecution recalled as dropped; Interference with filmmaking

4. **Field Recording: We Are Removing a Dictator**
International Documentary Association (essay by Moses Bwayo). 25 April 2024.
Read source at www.documentary.org
Coverage: March 2022 relocation to the United States; Seeking asylum; Reported threats and attempted kidnappings of his wife

5. **2026 Sundance Film Festival unveils 97 selected projects**
Sundance Institute. 10 December 2025.
Read source at www.sundance.org
Coverage: Bwayo credited as producer of KikuyuLand; Selection for the 2026 program; announcement alone is not evidence that a premiere actually occurred

6. **High Court Kampala Civil Division cause list, 10-14 November 2025**
Judiciary of Uganda. 7 November 2025.
Read source at judiciary.go.ug
Coverage: Listing of HCT-00-CV-MC-0019-2022 under the name Moses Bwayo; Inspector General of Police and Attorney General named as respondents; Declaratory orders and costs listed; identity, linkage, actual hearing and result not established